



Portfolio

www.mikkeltkoster.com

Mikkel Køster

Design at scale · Player-coach · Maker

About me

With **+15 years shaping digital products** across complex organisations, including **+8 years in design leadership** roles, I build and lead multidisciplinary design teams, set product design direction, and stay **hands-on close to the craft**. I still design myself, day to day, to keep my own craft sharp and stay credible with the people I lead. My approach bridges **strategic vision and executional craft**: I mentor designers, champion user-centricity at the leadership table, and create the conditions for teams to do their best work.

In brief

- **Head of Product Design** at Formalize, building design from zero across 2 compliance solutions.
- **Lead UX Designer** at Maersk, leading 12 designers across 20+ product teams on a supply chain platform.
- **Head of UX** at Sleepacy, designing an e-commerce platform from scratch around selling sleep.
- **Experience Design Director** at 1508, leading UX on Club Matas and Finansforbundet's digital transformation.
- **Sr. Experience Strategist** at Firstborn in NYC, leading UX on a skincare platform with a unique skin ID system.
- **Senior Experience Strategist** at NoA Ignite across Pocket Money, the first Danish bank debit card for kids.
- **Digital Advisor** at Monstarlab across connected product launches, mobile platforms, and the BMW i3 launch.
- **Co-founded** Riot Bernard, an online-only prescription eyewear brand in Shanghai.
- **Interned** at the world-renowned branding agency Wolff Olins in London.
- **Graduate** of The Kaospilots, a hybrid business and design school in Aarhus.

Sep 2026 - Now

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Freelance & Fractional

Hands-on product design and product strategy. Joining product teams on a freelance or fractional basis.

I work hands-on across product design and product strategy — discovery and framing, concepts, high-fidelity design, and design systems. I am used to joining an existing setup and working the way it already works: the stack, the rituals and the constraints as they are, with very little onboarding. Engagements run from a few weeks on a specific problem to ongoing fractional design leadership.

Sep 2024 - Sep 2026

2 years

www.formalize.com

Formalize helps companies stay ahead in the ever-evolving compliance landscape by offering a customizable compliance platform that streamlines governance, risk, and compliance (GRC) processes.

• Formalize

Head of Product Design

Built the design function from zero at a hyper-growth compliance startup operating in a trust-critical, regulation-heavy domain, where poor UX isn't just friction, it's a liability.

- Built a senior team from scratch: 2 Principal Product Designers, 1 Staff Designer and 1 Senior Product Designer
- Built a component-based design system enabling fast, consistent delivery across two core products
- Led a full platform redesign, modernizing the experience for compliance professionals
- Moved design from afterthought to strategic partner, central to the company's €30M fundraise narrative

Jul 2021 - Sep 2024

3 years 3 months

www.maersk.com

Maersk's Supply Chain Platform is an integrated end-to-end supply chain platform that handles complicated logistics processes - allowing customers more time to concentrate on their core business. The vision is to become the global integrator of container logistics.

• Maersk

Lead UX Designer

Led the design vision for Maersk's end-to-end supply chain platform — one of Denmark's most ambitious digital transformations, serving 350+ users across 20+ product teams and 260 engineers.

- Scaled the team from 6 to 12 in, establishing pillars for Product Design, Design Systems, and UX Research
- Led Flea Market, a design system that unified patterns platform-wide and cut technical and design debt
- Untangled complex, data-heavy workflows into intuitive experiences, aligning 20+ teams and 260 engineers
- Secured executive buy-in for earlier UX involvement and held keynotes for the Maersk design community

Jan 2021 – Jul 2021

6 months

Hilding Anders Group is one of the world's leading bed and mattress producers and has embarked on a global, digital transformation, accelerating its mission to "Improve Life Through Sleep" through the brand Sleepacy

Sleepacy

Head of UX

- Designed an e-commerce site from scratch for the Sleepacy brand.
- Drove a new app concept offering "Sleep Services" from initial concept through prototypes to user validation and final design.
- Led external design and development agencies to align on a shared product vision

Oct 2018 – Jan 2021

2 years 4 months

www.1508.dk

1508 helps companies build valuable services, experiences or processes to accelerate their digital transformation and innovation. 1508 designs what matters.

1508

Experience Design Director, Jun 2019 – Jan 2021 | 1 year 8 months

Senior Experience Strategist, Oct 2018 – Jun 2019 | 9 months

- **Club Matas:** UX lead on Denmark's largest loyalty app (1.5M members), designed end-to-end from scratch. App Store rating 4.8 from +32,800 reviews.
- **Finansforbundet:** UX lead on digital transformation, conceptualizing and designing 8 new digital products.
- **Dansk Metal:** UX lead on 'Mit Metal', a job search app for unemployed members. 66% of eligible members use it weekly. iOS rating 4.0.

Apr 2018 – Oct 2018

6 months

Firstborn is a design and innovation company who works with forward-looking companies to shape modern brands for a purpose-driven future. Named #7 best U.S. Design Studio.

Firstborn

New York

Senior Experience Strategist

- UX and concept lead on a new skincare platform — created a unique skin ID system to personalize product discovery for users
- Led internal teaching on design thinking, hypothesis-driven design, and working more agile in smaller teams

Jan 2014 – Jan 2018

4 years

www.noaignite.com

NoA Ignite designs and builds digital flagship experiences with the power to evoke emotions – the secret sauce to long term growth. NoA Ignite is on Fast Company's prestigious 'Most Innovative Companies' list in 2023!

NoA Ignite

Senior Experience Strategist, Apr 2016 – Jan 2018 | 1 year 10 months

Digital Strategist, Jan 2014 – Apr 2016 | 2 years 4 months

- **Danske Bank:** UX and strategy lead on 'Pocket Money', the first app from a major bank combining a debit card with money management for children aged 8–14
- **Varier:** UX lead on an award-winning app promoting healthy sitting habits. Won Experimental category at Danish Digital Awards 2016, displayed at IFA Berlin

May 2013 – Jan 2014

9 months

www.monstarlab.com

Monstarlab (former Nodes) delivers expert engineering and stunningly designed digital solutions to unleash growth for businesses, customers, and society.

Monstarlab

Former Nodes

Digital Advisor

- Advised clients on digital strategy and mobile UX across connected product launches and digital platforms
- Designed the user experience for a platform facilitating the BMW i3 launch in partnership with YouTube
- Conceptualized digital experience concepts for TDC, including consumer support and child safety applications

Oct 2011 – Apr 2013

1 year 7 months

www.thinkhouse.dk

Thinkhouse is a creative communication agency focusing on concept development of trade campaigns across all media platforms.

Thinkhouse

Creative Project Manager

- Led digital campaign strategy and creative production for major brands including Coca-Cola, Carlsberg, Tuborg, Mars, and Snickers
- Bridged offline and digital execution — integrating campaign events with social and digital media strategies

Mar 2011 – Oct 2011

9 months

Riot Bernard sold stylish prescriptive glasses with a rebellious brand — online only. For every pair bought, we donated a pair to a person in need.



Riot Bernard

Shanghai

Co-Founder

- Co-founded an online-only prescription eyewear brand with a buy-one-donate-one model, challenging the conventional optical market
- Led brand, marketing, and logistics during launch, including establishing key partnerships during a pivotal stay in Shanghai

Oct 2010 – Jan 2011

4 months

www.wolffolins.com

Wolff Olins help create transformative brands that move businesses, people and the world forward.



Wolff Olins

London

Intern

- Developed creative tools and facilitated co-creation workshops for clients including American Express and Skype at one of the world's leading brand consultancies
- Contributed to concept development and research across client engagements

Aug 2008 – Jun 2011

3 years

www.kaospilot.dk

The Kaospilots is a 3-year hybrid business and design school focusing on leadership and entrepreneurship.



The Kaospilots

Student

- Three-year hybrid business, design, and leadership programme — ranked among the world's most innovative schools by BusinessWeek and FastCompany
- Focused on leadership, entrepreneurship, and project-based learning in real-world contexts

Key skills



Design leadership

Setting direction across complex product ecosystems; design vision, principles, and quality standards.



Design systems

Building and governing design systems; ensuring consistency across large engineering organizations.



Team building & mentorship

Hiring, structuring, and growing multidisciplinary design teams; psychological safety and high-talent-density cultures.



Stakeholder collaboration

Working across product, engineering, and executive stakeholders; communicating design strategy and securing buy-in.



UX & user research

User-centred design end-to-end; discovery, synthesis, prototyping, testing, and iteration at scale, increasingly supported by AI tools.



Craft, prototyping & AI

Hands-on in Figma and AI-assisted design tools; from rough concept to high-fidelity interaction design, using AI to accelerate discovery, iteration, and delivery.